

A wooden shelf holds a variety of items: a small potted plant, a beaker with pink liquid, a pitcher, a row of colorful books, and another potted plant. To the left, a large orange sphere with horizontal stripes and a smaller blue and white sphere hang from thin lines. To the right, a large blue U-shaped pipe with white bands is visible, with several small colored spheres floating nearby.

Questions kick off these scientific journeys, and curiosity is their fuel. Answers don't bring these trips to an end, but rather take them down new and exciting paths that lead to even more discovery.

And while this book highlights some of the amazing thinkers and explorers whose work is rightfully celebrated, most of them didn't work alone. There are teams and generations of people behind each of these milestones. Science is a tapestry that weaves together the work of many, and it builds upon the discoveries and questions of the past.

As you'll see in this book, science is everywhere, as long as you keep your mind open to wonder. And you can be a scientist too—the next time you ask why, or look closely, or dream up an invention, that's you starting on that scientific journey. Let yourself see where it takes you. It will be awesome.

